New Orleans Saints offense

Scouting report for the Bears · 2026 Week 11 · Saints at Bears, Sun Nov 22, 2026

Line: CHI -9.5 · O/U 48.5 · Model estimate (Elo v1 (cloud)): CHI 70% to win (market 80%). Not betting advice.
Data through Week 9 (8 games). Only games before this week are used. Ranks are among all 32 teams.

Roster changes: no in-season trades for NO; CHI added DT Jeffery Simmons

Date	Team	Player	Move	Before the move	Games since
Oct 29	CHI in	⚠ DT Jeffery Simmons	from TEN	87% of TEN def. snaps, 7 games	2 of 9

nflverse's trade feed has nothing after Aug 28, 2025; newer trades come from the hand-kept list and weekly rosters.

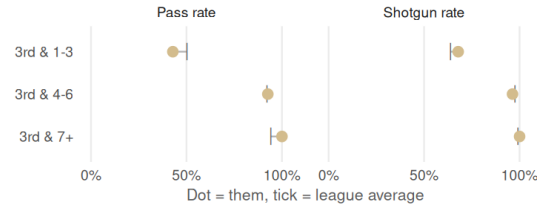
3 things to know

1. **Red zone:** 2nd-most shotgun, 76% in shotgun (league avg 57%). 75 plays
2. **2-minute:** 2nd-most efficient passing game, +0.37 EPA per dropback (league avg +0.04). 54 plays
3. **3rd & 7+:** the NFL's most pass-heavy, 100% pass rate (league avg 94%). 49 plays

Early downs: close to the league's expected pass rate

Metric	Value	NFL rank	League avg	Last season	Plays
Pass rate	59%	7th	55%	58% (7th)	356
Pass rate over expected	-1 pts	14th	-2 pts	-2 pts (15th)	356
Shotgun rate	64%	5th	55%	75% (6th)	356
EPA per play	-0.07	25th	+0.00	-0.06 (28th)	356

3rd & 7+: they throw 100% of the time (league 94%, the NFL's most pass-heavy)



Distance	Pass rate	EPA/play	Plays
3rd & 1-3	43% (25th)	+0.20 (11th)	28*
3rd & 4-6	93% (16th)	-0.24 (26th)	27*
3rd & 7+	100% (1st)	-0.10 (17th)	49

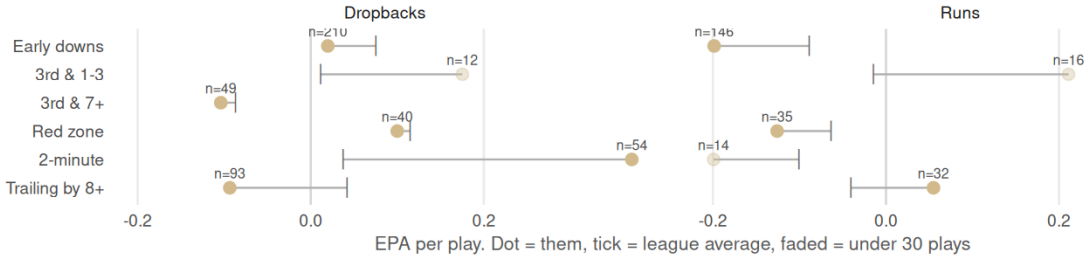
Red zone: balanced (53% pass rate)

Metric	Value	NFL rank	League avg	Last season	Plays
Pass rate	53%	16th	53%	53% (19th)	75
Pass rate over expected	-4 pts	15th	-5 pts	-10 pts (27th)	75
EPA per play	-0.01	18th	+0.04	-0.11 (24th)	75

Tendency shifts: 1 change in the last 4 games

Situation	Metric	Season	Last 4	Change	Plays (last 4)
Early downs	Pass rate over expected	-1 pts	-4 pts	-3 pts	163
Early downs	Shotgun rate	64%	67%	+3 pts	163
Early downs	EPA per play	-0.07	-0.09	-0.02	163
3rd & 1-3	Pass rate	43%	40%	-3 pts	10*
Red zone	Pass rate	53%	41%	**-13 pts**	37
All neutral downs	EPA per play	-0.03	-0.02	+0.01	217

Most dangerous: passes in the 2-minute drill (+0.37 EPA per play vs. +0.04 league)



How to read this. Pass rate counts sacks and scrambles as passes. *Pass rate over expected* compares their pass rate with what an average team calls in the same down, distance, field position, score and time (nflverse `xpass` model). EPA = expected points added; above 0 is good for the offense. Early downs, 3rd down, red zone and "all neutral" use only plays when the offense's win probability was 5–95%. The 2-minute and trailing-by-8+ splits use every play. Numbers marked * are under 30 plays: treat them as a hint, not a tendency. Shift = last 4 games differ from the season by 5+ points (0.10 EPA) on 30+ plays. Roster changes lists in-season trades (nflverse trade feed plus a hand-kept list) and other moves seen in weekly rosters; a regular (starting QB, 15%+ of targets, 30%+ of carries, or 60%+ of snaps before the move) is marked ⚠. Data: nflverse play-by-play (nflfastR / nflreadr), openly licensed. Built by Chris Antosiewicz · source.